

such options. If you have already have the correct settings for white balance, exposure and contrast on your image, then these settings are usually not required and you should make it a point not to go overboard with these effects. But the major retouches you'll want to do in this step are selective enhancements, be it spot removal of dust blemishes, creative sharpening (like the eyes of someone in a portrait), or selective noise reduction in otherwise smooth areas (like skin or the sky). All good photo editing software will provide you with a gamut of options for these activities, like a healing brush, clone tool, layer masks, and other similar adjustment tools.

After you've achieved the final desired "look" of the photograph and saved a final copy, the next step depends on how and whether you intend to use or share this image. Using a process called "digital image interpolation" you'll need to resize the file whenever you alter the display size of your photo, and the resize strategy will differ depending on whether you intend to make the image larger or smaller. While upsizing images, remember to perform the enlargements yourself instead of having it done by the printer, else it's easy to create prints which appear digital/ pixilated. Similarly when downsizing an image you should make sure you avoid introducing non-image patterns such as moiré artifacts on top of tiled roofs etc. Either way, what's often even more important than the resizing is that it is duly followed



Faceoff

by output sharpening next. Output sharpening is usually the very last step in post processing of images and has settings customized for the particular output device, including due considerations for the size, type or viewing distance of a print as applicable. This process is particularly useful to offset any softening caused by the resizing of your image for the web or mail.